



Henri Rousseau, *The Sleeping Gypsy* (1897)

PSYCHOSOCIAL RESEARCH ROUNDS

Improving Sleep Health in Post-Secondary Students: Evidence-Based Coping Strategies and Knowledge Translation Tools

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Session chaired by Vincent Paquin, MD

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2:00 PM – 2:30 PM (ET)

Amphitheatre (ICFP), 4333 Côte-St-Catherine Rd., Montreal QC H3T 1E4

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Learning objectives

- To synthesize the current evidence on interventions for common parasomnias and sleep-related disorders and translate this evidence into accessible, evidence-informed resources for young adults and healthcare professionals.
- To bridge the gap between research evidence and practical sleep health resources for post-secondary students.
- To identify evidence-based behavioural, psychological, pharmacological, and educational interventions for common parasomnias.

Abstract

Background: Sleep disturbances and parasomnias are common among post-secondary students and can adversely affect mental health, academic performance, and overall well-being.

Objective: This project represents the knowledge translation phase of a broader mixed-methods study examining parasomnias and sleep-related difficulties among post-secondary students. It aimed to synthesize current evidence on interventions for common parasomnias and translate these findings into accessible, evidence-informed coping strategies and educational resources for students, campus services, and healthcare professionals.

Methods: A student research team conducted a literature review of evidence-based interventions for common parasomnias and sleep disorders. Findings from the broader mixed-methods study, including student-reported coping strategies, resilience factors, and psychological functioning, were integrated with the literature. Consultations with sleep specialists, primary care physicians, and post-secondary students informed the development of bilingual knowledge translation materials.

Results: The literature identified a range of effective behavioural, psychological, lifestyle, and pharmacological interventions for common parasomnias. These include sleep hygiene, cognitive-behavioural approaches, stress reduction, imagery rehearsal therapy, scheduled awakenings, melatonin, clonazepam, and other disorder-specific treatments. These findings contributed to the development of evidence-based deliverables, including a website, educational videos, posters, and digital resources designed to promote prevention, early recognition, and appropriate referral in post-secondary settings.

Conclusion: Translating research evidence into practical, accessible resources has the potential to improve awareness and management of parasomnias among post-secondary students while supporting campus wellness services and healthcare providers. Future research should evaluate the effectiveness and implementation of these knowledge translation resources across post-secondary institutions.

About

Noemi Di Pietrantonio is a third-year undergraduate Psychology student at McGill University, pursuing minors in Behavioural Science and Education. She is a student researcher at the Lady Davis Institute for Medical Research, Jewish General Hospital, working under the supervision of Dr. Dorrie Rizzo, contributing to research on parasomnias and sleep-related difficulties among post-secondary students. Her work focuses on reviewing evidence-based interventions and translating research findings into accessible educational resources

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